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MONTHLY UPDATE

# Digital Payments and Fintech: monthly update, July 2026

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*42 places. Every block below is carried verbatim from that place's own monthly update, where it was written, sourced and checked; nothing is written here.*

*The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.*

## Algeria

The Bank of Algeria hosted the [29th ordinary meeting of the Arab Commission for Payment and Settlement Systems](#) in Algiers on 27 July. No instrument was concluded.

## Angola

Two payment milestones fell within a fortnight. The central bank completed migration of domestic payments to the international messaging standard on 10 July across the switch, the exchange and the real-time settlement participants. And on 27 July the [kwanza was formally introduced into the regional real-time settlement system](#) — the second currency added since that system launched in 2013 — against 2025 trade and interbank flows with the other fourteen member states of about US\$3.77bn across nine currencies.

## Burkina Faso

The regional instant-payment rail moved its deadlines rather than its coverage: the central bank [extended connection to 30 September 2026 for banks and payment institutions and 30 June 2027 for microfinance](#), with 80 institutions connected union-wide at 24 June and 74 more in test.

## Burundi

The same EAC central bank governors [agreed to accelerate the East African Monetary Union roadmap and welcomed progress on the Regional Cross-Border Payment System Master Plan](#). On their own account the plan's first activities are work plans and resource mobilisation — design, not deployment.

## Cameroon

Payments had the month's densest run. On 9 July the regional central bank [joined the pan-African settlement system, extending it to all six member states and 72m people](#), with member-state banks to be integrated by end-2026; no Cameroonian bank is yet named as live on it. On 29 July an [interoperable QR-code standard launched](#)

[under a regional regulation of 8 April](#), letting any bank, microfinance or mobile-money application scan any merchant code across the six states. A day later a [consultation opened on revising the switch's tariff grid](#), the operator conceding that current pricing penalises low-value transactions and drives artificial splitting of payments; no revised grid or effective date is published.

## Central African Republic

Mobile money is the salary rail outside the banked areas, and it failed with the network. The most recent enrolment figure held remains [1,702 civil servants in regions without banking services](#), recorded as a project achievement in May 2025; at the affected town, [prepaid bundles expired unused while the network was down](#).

On 30 July a memorandum was signed at Bangui covering [digital finance and land banking, presented as mobilising investment for infrastructure while modernising land administration](#). No commitment figure, disbursement schedule or governance arrangement is stated, and it couples a payments ambition and a land-registry ambition under one offshore private counterparty.

## Chad

On 24 July the Ministry of Finance took delivery of [3,000 smart electronic payment terminals](#) supplied under the World Bank-financed *Projet d'appui à la transformation numérique*, intended to digitise collection of public revenue; the ministry named no deployment schedule, target sites or per-agency allocation.

The 2027 budget orientations, reported 4 August, [restate](#) the mandate for exclusive electronic payment of state obligations — bank or mobile transfer only, against a standardised electronic invoice — for a start of 1 January 2027. The same regime had already been [mandated for budget year 2026](#) — exclusively bank or mobile payments, cash and cheques out; nothing in the base shows that 2026 mandate operating, so the restatement is a year's slip rather than a new commitment. Chad had already launched the standardised electronic invoice itself, among the first CEMAC states to do so, under the 2026 budget; the August orientations move only the exclusivity date.

On 29 July, at Douala, the BEAC and GIMAC [launched the CEMAC's interoperable QR-code payment standard](#), in force under a monetary-union regulation of 8 April 2026 across all six member states including Chad and letting any bank, mobile-money or microfinance account settle a purchase at any merchant's code, routed and settled through the regional switch. No Chadian bank, wallet or merchant deployment is on record: Chad is covered by the regulation rather than shown live.

## Congo

On 3 August the [public-revenue platform went live on the national payments switch](#), payment following a declaration, authenticated, reconciled in real time and routed to the treasury against a secured electronic receipt. Roll-out runs at large then medium enterprises, all taxpayers targeted by end-2026 and no wave dates published. The same account records the [treasury single account at the regional central bank still being finalised](#).

## Cote d'Ivoire

A private schools federation signed a convention on 21 July putting fee collection onto mobile money in a 200-school pilot from August. The flat FCFA 100 agency fee levied on every mobile-money counter transaction since November 2025 was [documented on 24 July](#) as authorised by no operator tariff and no regulator, regressive by construction on small transfers.

## DR Congo

A card-network executive confirmed on 2 July a [live use case settling mobile-wallet top-ups in stablecoins in the background](#), bypassing correspondent banking. On 14 July a card network and a domestic payments company announced [prepaid card issuance](#), the domestic partner serving more than three million customers through 4,000 agents.

## Egypt

Two things moved on the payment rails. The instant payment network [began crediting inbound cross-border remittances instantly at all banks operating in Egypt](#). And factoring, where the platform now [vets invoices before financing to enforce the ban on double-funding a receivable](#), against factored paper up 77.8% in 2025 to EGP 132.2bn.

## Eswatini

Three days after the FinScope survey launch, a Ministry of Finance portfolio committee [reported charges differing between institutions for equivalent services and higher than comparable banks in the sub-region](#), recommending the central bank benchmark them against SACU and Common Monetary Area banks within 30 days of adoption. The dated figure on the record is a withdrawal of E4,000 attracting E79 to E89 in fees; the ministry replied that the bank concerned had not raised charges but moved to real-time display of each fee.

Cross-border, an account published on 21 July established two things by implication. Eswatini's central bank governor [discussed leveraging Egyptian experience to accelerate PAPSS accession](#), which places Eswatini outside PAPSS as at that date. The same account reports low-value Common Monetary Area transactions migrating off domestic electronic-funds-transfer rails onto the TCIB scheme, with no timetable, volume, value or mandating instrument given.

## Ethiopia

Payments extended into utilities and tax. Prepaid electricity purchase entered the mobile-money super app on 29 July for smart-meter customers, and a digital tax-payment service for one regional revenue bureau launched on 28 July as the first of a planned series.

## Gabon

Domestic acceptance figures published on 30 July put banks at 457,377 cardholders among 673,793 clients, against 326 cash machines and 1,535 merchant terminals; of 1,101,434 transactions in June, 62.41 per cent were cash withdrawals and 24.61 per cent terminal payments ([bank association](#)).

## Gambia

Government collection acquired a fourth channel. The Office of the Accountant General [signed a memorandum integrating the SUTURA platform into revenue collection](#), reported on 20 July 2026 — domestically built, distributed through the postal service, alongside the Yonna Wallet arrangement of March 2026. The Deputy Accountant General said several commercial banks are already integrated; the text is not held and no go-live date, volume or fee structure is given.

## Ghana

Central bank data for June 2026 put mobile money at [954 million transactions worth GH¢492.9bn](#), against GH¢323.2bn a year earlier, on 84.6 million registered wallets of which 26.4 million were active; interoperable transfers were GH¢6.2bn, about 1.3% of value.

Enforcement of the digital-credit regime opened. A notice of 20 July recorded the 30 June licensing deadline as elapsed, and a notice of [3 August named twenty unlicensed lending applications](#), cautioning banks and payment providers against processing for them and framing the harm first as a violation of customer data privacy. The promised register of licensed providers remains unpublished.

## Guinea

[NimbaPay opened for operations on 22 July 2026](#), making banks, electronic-money institutions and microfinance institutions interoperable nationwide. The governor of the central bank put financial-account access at 4% in 2011 and about 36% in 2024, and named state payments and cross-border payments as the next phases. It was [built in 127 days on Mojaloop open source by Guinéeenne de Monétique, with AfricaNenda and Thitsa Works, expressly so that the state retains control of the infrastructure](#). The following day the central bank stated that [more than 70% of payments are still made in cash even at merchants already equipped with electronic solutions](#), and named interoperable merchant QR codes and fiscal incentives as workstreams under study. Its [project register records the RTGS migration to ISO 20022 held by unpaid invoices to the supplier CMA and customs clearance, and PAPSS participation with no transaction recorded](#).

## Kenya

Borrowers can [repay Hustler Fund loans in loyalty points from 23 July](#), five points settling one shilling, recovering KSh 3m in the first week. A second operator launched a merchant wallet on 3 August.

## Lesotho

Vodacom Financial Services and STANLIB Lesotho launched [Tsetela](#) at the Mpilo Boutique Hotel in Maseru on Wednesday 22 July 2026 — the date fixed by [Vodacom Lesotho's own announcement of that day](#), against two press accounts that dated it relatively. Eligible individual M-Pesa customers can invest from M50 and Mokhatlo group-savings customers from M300, with balances, daily interest and withdrawals over USSD on \*200#. STANLIB Lesotho is licensed by the Central Bank of Lesotho, with segregated investor funds, annual audit and an independent trustee.

Standard Bank's [extension of CIPS renminbi settlement](#) beyond South Africa, reported on 27 July, names Lesotho as one of five added markets.

## Liberia

The central bank's fee schedule for interoperable transfers was reported on 5 August: [1.0% of value from US\\$1.00 to US\\$2,000.00 and a flat US\\$25.00 above that, available 24 hours a day](#). The flat cap falls below 1.0% of value above about US\$2,500 and keeps falling.

On 28 July the finance minister named the [national electronic payment switch as the enabler of a 24-hour economy, with creative-sector support to enter the 2027 budget](#). No go-live date was given.

## Libya

On 30 July the Central Bank said it had received July disbursement authorisations from the Ministry of Finance and referred them to the commercial banks for execution through Ratibak Lahzi, putting enrolment at [about 1.7 million public employees, 76%](#), and said work continues with the ministry to automate complaint intake and the handling of unexecuted salaries.

## Madagascar

On 3 August MVola's new director general [gave the first account of the platform migration behind the outages of May and June](#). The core platform was replaced in May 2026; he states that money does not vanish from accounts, that reported cases have been regularised, and that the platform is stabilised with further work outstanding. No regulator is named, no incident report is published and no compensation is mentioned. Separately, [Airtel Money integrated Baobab Bank into its mobile banking service on 17 July](#).

## Malawi

On 25 July the central bank's expected banknote replacement cost for 2026 was reported at MWK 69.8bn against MWK 50.6bn in 2025, with an economists' association president naming government levies on digital money transfers as a reason cash use persists.

## Mali

On 27 July a ministry field visit [recorded the social security fund's bank-payment pilot for pensions as complete and ready for phased rollout](#).

## Mauritius

The [omnibus bill of 24 July](#) puts the National Fintech Governance Committee on a statutory footing from 1 September 2026 — minister-chaired, seating the central bank governor, the financial regulator's chief executive, two ministries, the investment board and four private-sector members, empowered to approve sector-wide standards, and expressly not a body corporate. It was announced with the [fintech strategy on 25 June](#) and reached statute within a month.

On cross-border payments the state operator [announced a Mauritius-Seychelles corridor as a launch](#); no corroborating record from the partner fintech or either central bank is on file. A [South African Reserve Bank spokesperson said on 29 July that Mauritius is among four states considering onboarding to the Southern African settlement system](#) by end-2027 — another central bank's account of Mauritian intent.

## Mozambique

The National Payments System Law took effect on 2 July 2026, replacing the regime in force since 2008 and extending the central bank's inspection and supervision over electronic-money institutions and new payment service providers ([enactment account](#)). On 30 July the central bank reported the instant payment system carrying more than 11,000 transfers a day, a tripling since it entered production in March ([communique account](#)).

## Namibia

The central bank, the instant payments company and the clearing house signed a declaration of intent on 2 July to integrate instant payments with the national clearing infrastructure, publishing no deliverables, funding or timetable ([declaration account](#)).

The payments association's annual general meeting on 28 July also heard that licensing and supervision of payment providers will move to the central bank, with no instrument, commencement date or transition plan published ([central bank account](#)).

## Niger

On 29 July the higher education minister said the grants agency reform consists of [acquiring database software and routing scholarship and social-aid payments through the banking system via the Treasury's application](#); no budget, vendor, timetable or beneficiary count was published.

## Nigeria

Payments produced real-time reporting of every licensed bureau's FX purchases from 15 July.

On 2 August an account of African corporate venture capital recorded that [tier-one Nigerian banks hold payments infrastructure inside the group rather than at arm's length](#), and that the central bank has begun regulating fintech ownership as well as conduct. The base carries no earlier statement of the ownership position, so no change can be stated.

The central bank then set out what it wants that infrastructure to look like. A circular [imposes market-structure caps of 25% on card issuing and 15% on acquiring, mandatory localisation of payment data by 1 January 2027, and disclosure of ultimate beneficial owners](#) on banks, fintechs and payment service providers, against an estimated US\$850m a year spent on offshore hosting and about 90% of Nigerian payment data currently held abroad. Those figures are the analysing firm's estimates and the circular text itself is not held.

Three admission gates opened alongside it. The central bank [opened a second sandbox cohort to virtual-asset and data-enabled firms, applications running 12 to 31 August, and chairs a new Virtual Asset Council with the securities regulator and the revenue service](#), against an estimated US\$92.1bn transacted in cryptocurrency by Nigerians between July 2024 and June 2025; the securities regulator [admitted two further firms to its incubation programme, taking it to 12 since July](#). Neither publishes a graduation route or licensing outcome. The regulated naira stablecoin [went live on a public blockchain on 12 August](#), with no supply, holder count or reserve attestation published.

Taxation moved in the other direction. Peer-to-peer and over-the-counter traders [warned on 14 August that the 1.5% virtual-asset stamp duty and the taxes beside it could push activity into unregulated channels](#), the rules having been signed on 31 July. Separately the Lagos State revenue service is [testing whether creator-economy platform payouts are royalties subject to 5% withholding tax, pressing two named platforms to deduct at source](#) under the 2025 tax act — the same authority's earlier attempt to make a ride-hailing platform a collection agent being the precedent. No assessment, ruling or judgment is published in either matter.

## Rwanda

Effective 14 July the central bank [designated one rail as the national instant payment system](#) by directive, connecting 22 financial institutions bank to wallet to merchant in any direction, with a per-transaction ceiling. An interoperable bank-to-wallet transfer that could previously cost as much as RWF 5,000 now costs [a flat RWF 20 regardless of amount](#), about one US cent on the publisher's own conversion. The directive itself is not held.

The layer the rail does not touch moved the other way. Regulator statistics for the first quarter of 2026, reported on 31 July, put the second operator's share of the mobile-money market at 14.3% against 16.9% a year earlier, and its active agents at 48,847 against 53,316 — a contraction in the cash-in and cash-out network on which rural households depend, over exactly the period interoperability was meant to help.

## Senegal

Digital settlement on the Dakar rapid-transit network reached [39% after a super-app was integrated on 15 July](#), against 10% previously, on a network carrying up to 300,000 passengers daily.

## Seychelles

NPCI International and the Central Bank of Seychelles signed a UPI memorandum during Prime Minister Modi's visit [on 29 June 2026](#), targeting a rollout by the end of the year. Acting Commissioner General Fred Morel confirmed the [Revenue Commission's mandatory e-invoicing procurement had reached its final stage by 23 July](#), following an Expression of Interest opened in March. Cabinet approved amendments to the Foreign Exchange Act 2009 on 22 July, widening the "authorised dealer" definition to credit unions and licensed payment service providers.



## Sierra Leone

A re-platforming of the national payment rails — real-time gross settlement and automated clearing — is reported to have been contracted in early August, but no award notice from the Bank of Sierra Leone or the procurement authority is published, and the aggregator listing that carried the figures is not an origin this base accepts. The award is not held, and no amount, supplier or scope is stated here on that basis.

The same 4 August ministerial statement [disclosed about 390 Orange mobile-money fraud complaints logged in 2026 to date and more than 18,000 police requests for subscriber data answered](#).

## Somalia

On 26 July the Central Bank set out how the instant payment system is to reach the whole market: [14 commercial banks and eight mobile money and e-wallet providers once integration completes, on ISO 20022, carrying person-to-person, merchant, government-to-person and person-to-government flows, with business-facing services still in development](#). The system is operated by the Somalia Payment Switch, a joint venture of the Central Bank and 13 commercial banks, which the Governor described as a deliberate choice over central-bank-run infrastructure. One commitment is stated and undelivered: mobile money integration carries no published date.

## South Africa

Operation Vulindlela's quarterly report of 31 July recorded the Payments Ecosystem Modernisation programme moving beyond conceptual design into active development of a payment credential, wallet, governance and trust capabilities, with testing against government use cases dated November 2026. Nothing held states how that rail relates to the bank-API rails below.

The Reserve Bank gazetted a [national interoperable payment code standard](#), with PayShap the first rail to adopt it. Ozow launched a shared [bank application-programming-interface rail with FNB and RMB](#), its fourth such arrangement, and Pepkor announced a [R21.3bn merger of Flash and Shop2Shop](#), subject to approval.

## South Sudan

On 25 July, following a resolution of the Ministerial High-Level Committee on Economic Reform, the revenue authority [barred cash payment of tax at its offices](#). Liabilities in South Sudanese pounds must be deposited at designated banks and evidenced by an official slip before a receipt is issued; dollar-assessed taxes keep existing arrangements, and digital payment through Capital Pay continues. The authority states it as temporary.

## Sudan

[The Central Bank revoked the Al-Asjad payment-switch licence on 4 July 2026](#), days after the platform launched in Port Sudan with a Sovereignty Council representative present; no specific breach was disclosed, and unconfirmed press reports say the firm was incorporated only in late 2025 with a Dubai branch. [The national payment switch launched live on 6 August](#), connecting Omdurman National Bank as first and only participant and completing a first ATM withdrawal over the switch; the Central Bank's own framing is restoration of war-damaged infrastructure, not a new rail, and no schedule for connecting further banks was given. [Al Jazeera field reporting from Omdurman and](#)



[Khalifa markets on 31 July](#) found bank apps, chiefly Bankak, dominant in retail settlement, driven by cash scarcity and currency collapse rather than technology uptake, with recurring failure modes including no-smartphone workarounds, app outages and mistaken transfers.

## Tanzania

The [mandatory electronic payments order came into operation on 1 July 2026](#). It is an order under the electronic transactions Act rather than regulations, as widely mis-reported; it is prospective only, businesses taking cash at commencement have until 1 January 2027 to comply, and cash remains legal tender.

One month in, the price of using the rails became the argument. On 31 July the central bank [capped bank-to-wallet interoperability at TZS 5,000 above TZS 500,000, single instant transactions and retail bank-to-bank transfers at TZS 2,000, and card payments at zero](#), removing intra-bank transfer charges and a Zanzibar card surcharge. The same day the governor rejected a general price cap demanded by users and analysts; one analyst put the worked cost at about TZS 3,500 per TZS 100,000 paid and argued that the mandate manufactures avoidance.

A technical meeting in Zanzibar from 7 to 11 July [advanced the governance, commercial and risk frameworks for a cross-border instant-payment corridor with Rwanda](#). No launch date was set.

## Togo

Payments moved on a deadline. Retirement allowances [began paying by bank transfer and mobile money in July](#), and allowances stop on 31 August for beneficiaries who have not registered payment details; no beneficiary count or registration rate is published, and no alternative is stated for someone without a bank account, a handset or an identity document. The regional [deadline to connect to the instant payment platform moved from 30 June to 30 September](#), and to 30 June 2027 for microfinance institutions. A [treasury prepaid card was announced](#) with no timetable and no confirmation that a file has been lodged with the central bank.

## Uganda

Three payment arrangements were opened in the month, all private. A [licensed local-currency-in, stablecoin-out settlement corridor across four East African markets including Uganda](#) opened on 16 July with no volume or counterparty figure published. On 21 July [motor third-party insurance went on sale over a mobile-money channel](#) with a digital sticker issued online, framed by the insurance regulator as narrowing the protection gap; no premium, policy count or target was published. On 24 July a bank and a payments company [signed a memorandum on school-fees saving with payment-history-based financing, agent-network healthcare payments and digitised insurance](#). The signature date is unestablished, and nothing is on file about consent, retention or the legal basis for the credit-scoring layer.

## Zambia

On 27 July a vendor manager stated on the record that the National Financial Switch's intended reduction in customer transaction costs has not happened yet, that the central bank is only now focusing on it, and that the electronic clearing house is not yet live on the regional instant-payment scheme ([switch account](#)).

## Zimbabwe

The road authority took handover of an expanded toll plaza on 29 July with two of six lanes reserved for radio-frequency tag holders, a second plaza due the next day and a third under construction, against a stated programme covering all 29 tollgates; the announcement states nothing on retention, access or legal basis for the movement record the tags generate ([handover account](#)).

The switch operator reported interoperable quick-response payments in rollout and participation in a pan-African settlement system, with no merchant, acceptance-point or transaction count ([conference account](#)).

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